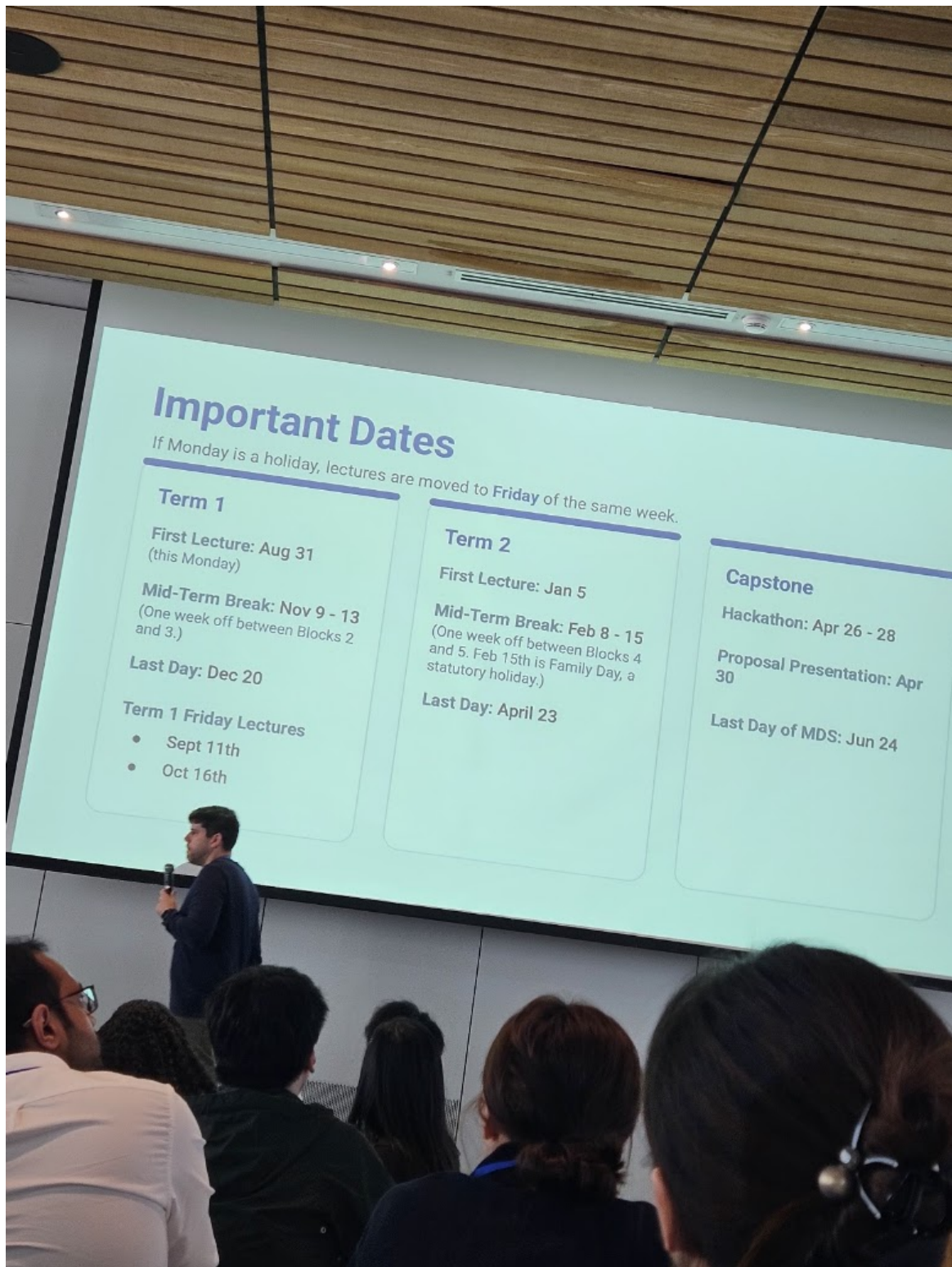


My first weeks in MDS

Isaac Wu

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Important Dates

If Monday is a holiday, lectures are moved to **Friday** of the same week.

Term 1

First Lecture: Aug 31
(this Monday)

Mid-Term Break: Nov 9 - 13
(One week off between Blocks 2 and 3.)

Last Day: Dec 20

Term 1 Friday Lectures

- Sept 11th
- Oct 16th

Term 2

First Lecture: Jan 5

Mid-Term Break: Feb 8 - 15
(One week off between Blocks 4 and 5. Feb 15th is Family Day, a statutory holiday.)

Last Day: April 23

Capstone

Hackathon: Apr 26 - 28

Proposal Presentation: Apr 30

Last Day of MDS: Jun 24

The first day of UBC MDS orientation was a solid start to the year. Even though I usually keep to myself as an introvert, the setup made it easy to spark up conversations. I ended up connecting with classmates from all over the world, each bringing completely different backgrounds to the table. It immediately felt like a strong, diverse group to go through the next ten months with.

The professors gave us a clear overview of the program structure, mapping out the progression through Term 1, Term 2, and the Capstone project. Seeing the dates on the screen made the timeline very real—from the weekly lecture flow to the break weeks built in between blocks. They didn't sugarcoat the workload either, warning us right off the bat not to overcommit our schedules because of how intensive the curriculum gets.

Leaving the room, the pace ahead felt pretty daunting, but having a good crew of people to work alongside makes a huge difference. I'm looking forward to getting past the intro stuff and diving into the actual coursework.